

Cruz & Cruz Kickoff Feedback Analysis

Strategic Pivot: Moving from Status
Updates to 'Progress as Storytelling'



VERSION: v0.3.5
DATE: 15 February 2026
FROM: Designer
TO: Sherpa, Dev, Journalist, Advocate, Architect

The Partnership Health Check

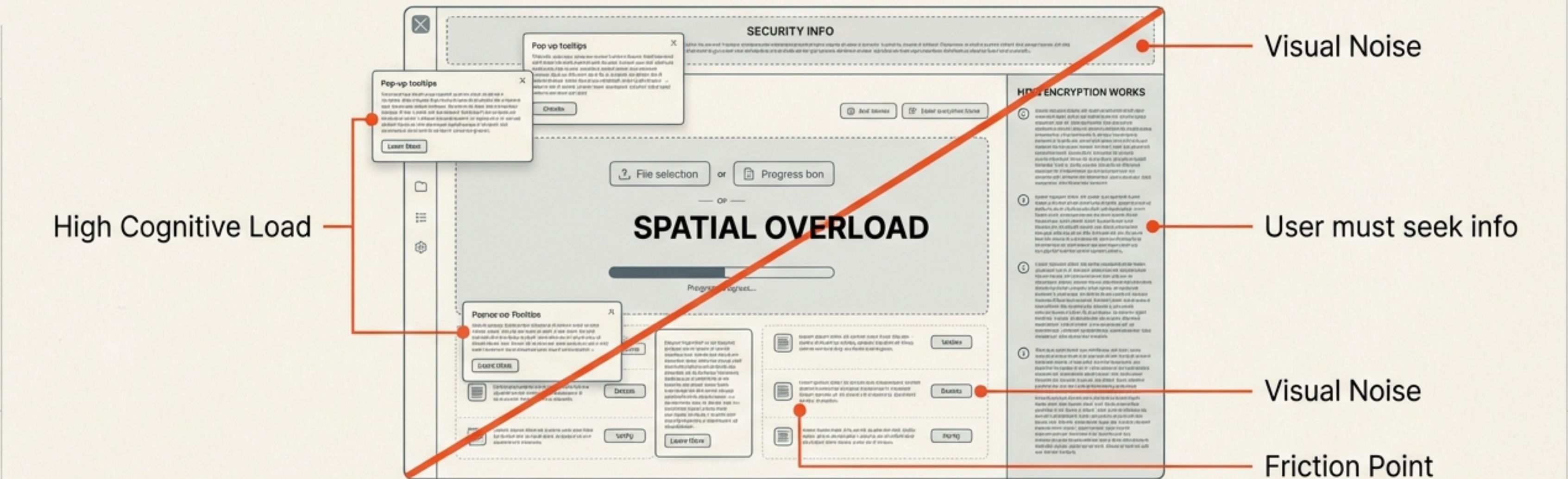
Cruz & Cruz have engaged substantively with the material, moving beyond aesthetics to core UX mechanics. The partnership is viable and high-value.

Scope & Complexity	Strategic Alignment	Innovation
 No Red Flags Zero-knowledge model fully understood.	 Global Mindset Strong alignment with i18n strategy (D017).	 The Pivot Delivered breakthrough concept CC-F004.

The Core Challenge: Explaining Zero-Knowledge

Previous 'Spatial' attempts resulted in cognitive overload.

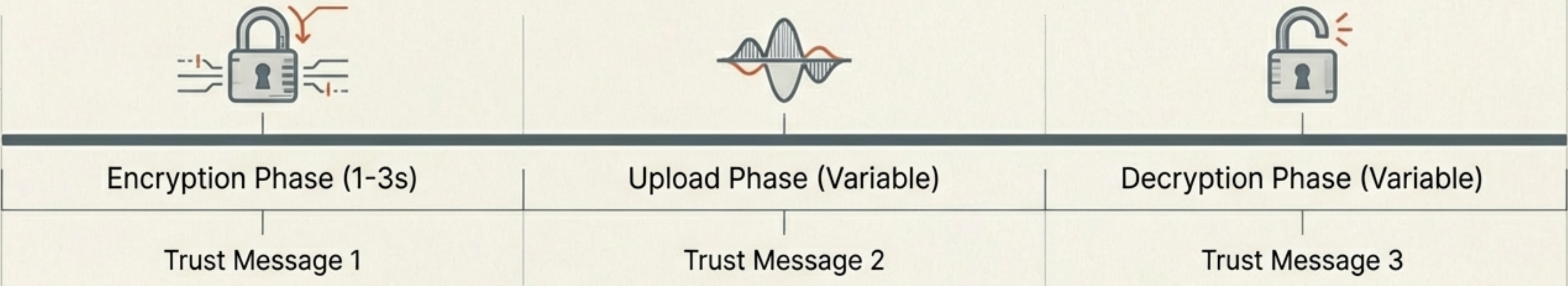
THE SPATIAL APPROACH



The Breakthrough: Progress as Storytelling

REF: CC-F004

THE TEMPORAL SOLUTION



“Use forced wait states to drip-feed trust information. The user is a captive audience.”

Turning Wait Time into Trust Time

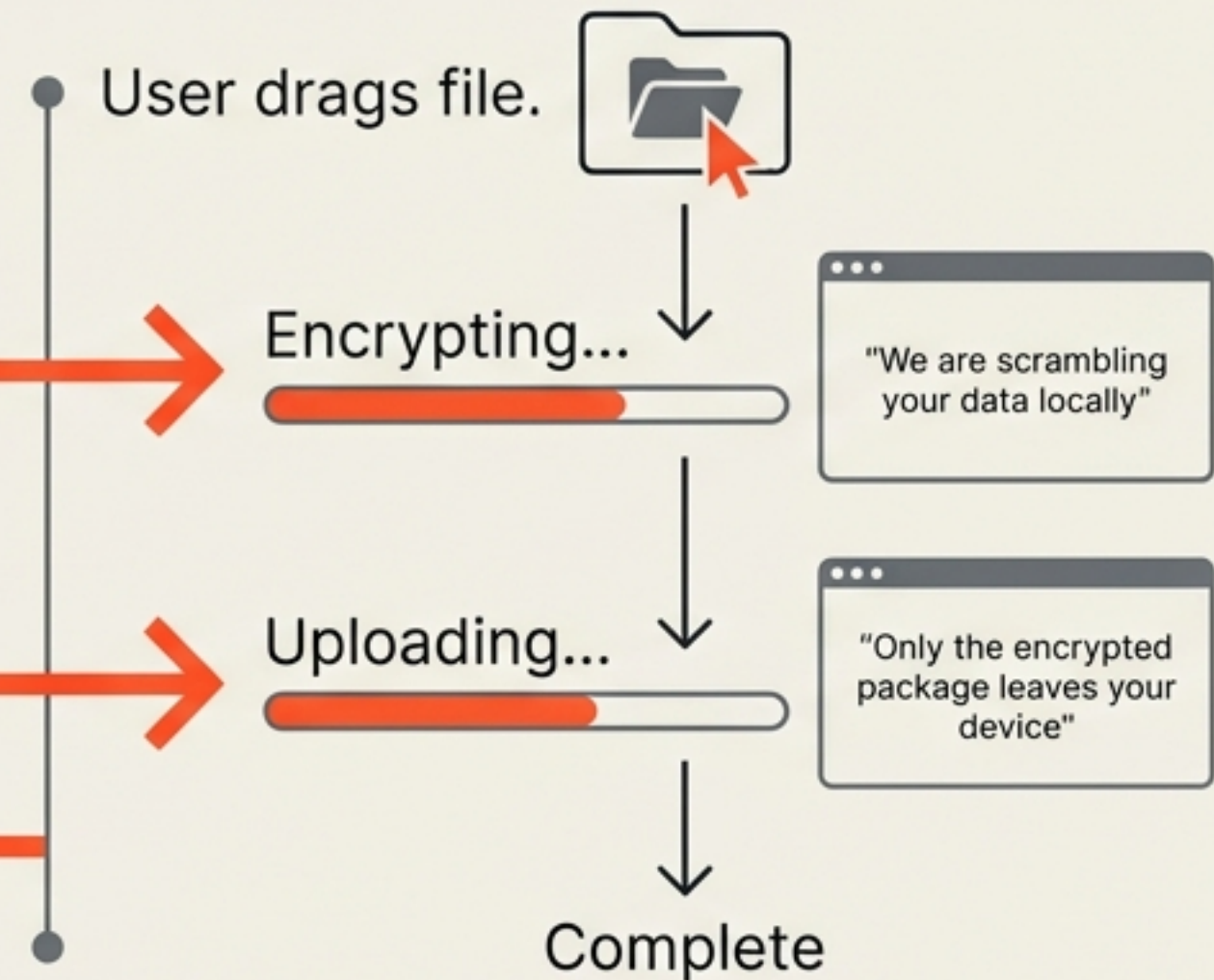
Old Spatial Model

F003: No indicator during encryption.

F006: What is Zero-Knowledge?

F013: No 'How It Works' page.

New Temporal Model

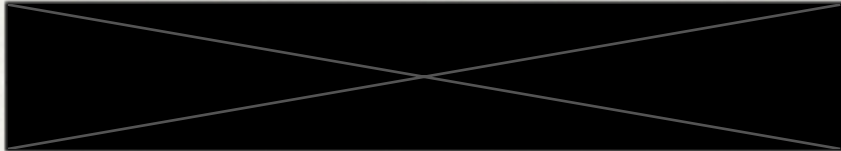


Design Order: Redesign upload components as 'multi-phase storytelling components'.

Terminology Cleanup: Killing the ‘Blob’

REF: CC-F002

Replacing internal jargon with user-centric trust language.

INTERNAL / CODE (Keep)	USER FACING (Scrub)	NEW STANDARD (Use)
 blob_storage encrypted_blob Status: Approved for API/Docs only.	✗ Encrypted blob ✗ Blob on server ✗ Blob contents	✓ Encrypted Data / File ✓ Encrypted Package ✓ Encrypted Contents

ACTION: Journalist to scrub from guidelines. Designer to police mockups.

Brand Stance: SGraph Stays

REF: CC-F001

S + Graph = → SGraph

Secure

Semantic + Product Family

The Feedback

Agency noted “Graph” is abstract for non-technical audiences.

The Rationale

The name serves the Product Family Strategy. Once SGraph Text ships, the name earns itself. Visual identity must do the heavy lifting.

Future Architecture: Pluggable Content Slots

REF : CC-F005



**Concept: Corporate
Messaging Extension**

Allow Enterprise Admins to replace default trust education with custom messaging.

Decision D049:
Build the UI architecture to accept external content sources. Do not implement the management UI yet.

Scoping the Cultural Research

REF: CC-F006



Priority Markets Only

1. Identify

Advocate to select top 3-5 markets by privacy awareness.

2. Research

Designer to audit color psychology for those specific regions.

3. Output

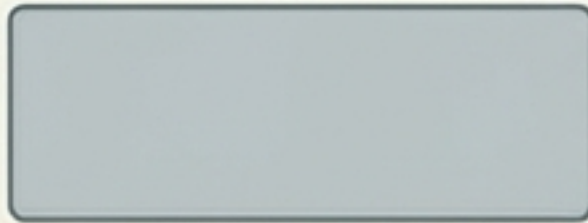
Theme Risk Assessment for Aurora, Glacier, and Ember palettes.

Constraint: Do not boil the ocean.

Transparency in Design

REF: CC-F007

THEME PICKER



Aurora



Glacier



Ember

Theme: Glacier

Why this theme? Designed for high contrast and low blue-light emission, inspired by Nordic privacy standards.

Does this work for you? [[Feedback Link](#)]

Decision D050: Theme Rationale Pages.

- Explain color and accessibility choices.
- Invite user feedback on cultural appropriateness.
- Builds trust through design transparency.

Decision Log: Confirmed Direction

REF: CC-F008

D048 Progress as Education APPROVED Use wait states for storytelling.	D049 Pluggable Content ARCHITECTURAL PROPOSAL Reserve slot for future B2B messaging.	D050 Theme Rationale APPROVED Public explanation pages + feedback loop.
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Action Routing: Creative & UX

REF: CC-F009



DESIGNER

- Brief Cruz & Cruz on 'Progress-as-Storytelling'.
- Ensure 'Blob' removal from all mockups.
- Lead cultural colour research (shortlist).



JOURNALIST

- Write progress phase messages (1 sentence max).
- Scrub 'Blob' from guidelines.
- Draft Theme Rationale content.

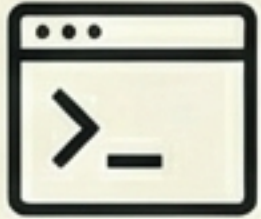


ADVOCATE

- Identify top 5 privacy markets.
- Validate message sequence for all personas.
- Define feedback questions.

Action Routing: Technical & Product

REF: CC-F010



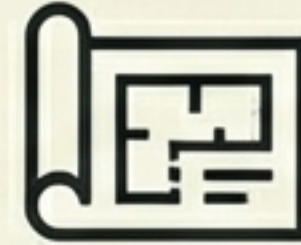
DEV

- Implement phase-aware rendering for progress components.
- Build IFD page for theme rationale.



SHERPA

- Review progress messages against Friction Log.
- Verify F003, F006, F013 resolution.



ARCHITECT / CONDUCTOR

- Update schema notes for display_messages.
- Add 'Corporate Messaging' to Explorer backlog.

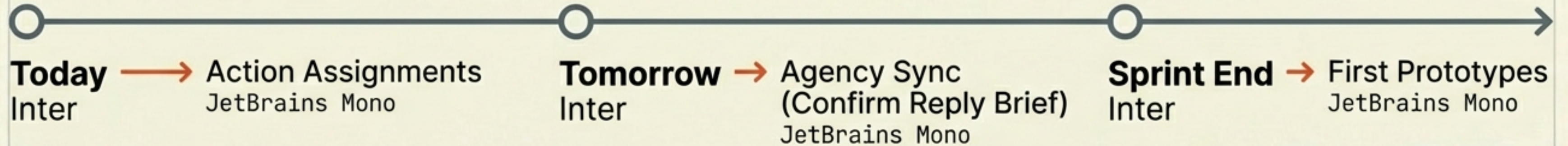
The Agency Reply Brief

Directives for Cruz & Cruz Session

REF: CC-F004

- 01.** **NAME:** Confirmed. Proceed with SGraph.
- 02.** **TERMINOLOGY:** 'Blob' is dead. Use 'Encrypted Data'.
- 03.** **UX PIVOT:** Green light on 'Progress as Storytelling' (CC-F004).
- 04.** **ARCHITECTURE:** Design progress bars with flexible content slots.
- 05.** **RESEARCH:** Focus color study on forthcoming market shortlist.
- 06.** **TRANSPARENCY:** Include 'Why this theme?' links in picker.

Next Steps & Timeline



**We are moving from explaining
our security to demonstrating it.**

Let's make the wait time count.